

Here's the full curation for **wheel**, anchored to **"a bench near the Ferris wheel."** This is a strong family: the physical **rotating circular object** develops into **vehicle steering, machinery, pottery, amusement rides, circular movement**, and figurative expressions involving **control, processes, relationships, and systems**. The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

WHEEL

1. Passage anchor

> "Soon, we were sitting on a bench near the **Ferris wheel** with cups of lemonade in our hands."

Passage meaning

Ferris wheel = a very large upright rotating wheel at an amusement park, with passenger cabins or seats attached around its edge

摩天輪

Here, **wheel** refers to the large circular rotating structure forming the main part of the amusement ride.

Practice

1. We could see the **Ferris wheel** from across the park.
我們從樂園另一邊也能看到**摩天輪**。
2. The **Ferris wheel** turned slowly above the theme park.
摩天輪在主題樂園上方緩緩轉動。

Core meanings of WHEEL

2. wheel — circular object that rotates

= circular object that turns around a central point or axle, especially to allow a vehicle or machine to move

輪 ; 輪子 ; 車輪

Examples

1. One of the bicycle **wheels** was damaged.
單車其中一個**車輪**壞了。
2. The cart has four **wheels**.
那輛手推車有四個**輪子**。

This is the central physical sense.

3. wheel — vehicle wheel

= round part of a car, bicycle, bus, etc. that turns against the ground

****車輪；輪胎所在的輪子****

Examples

1. The front ****wheel**** hit the curb.

前****車輪****撞上路緣。

2. The bicycle's back ****wheel**** began to wobble.

單車的後****輪****開始搖晃。

Strictly, the ****wheel**** and the ****tire/tyre**** are not the same thing.

Ferris wheel

4. Ferris wheel

= large vertical amusement ride consisting of a rotating wheel with passenger seats or cabins around it

****摩天輪****

This is the exact passage construction.

Examples

1. They rode the ****Ferris wheel**** at sunset.

他們在日落時乘坐****摩天輪****。

2. The lights on the ****Ferris wheel**** came on after dark.

天黑後，****摩天輪****的燈亮了起來。

Steering wheel

5. steering wheel

= wheel turned by a driver to control the direction of a vehicle

****方向盤****

Examples

1. Keep both hands on the ****steering wheel****.

雙手要放在****方向盤****上。

2. She turned the ****wheel**** sharply to the left.

她猛地把****方向盤****轉向左邊。

In driving contexts, ****the wheel**** alone very often means ****the steering wheel****.

6. the wheel — steering control

= steering wheel, especially when talking about driving or controlling a vehicle

****方向盤****

Examples

1. He fell asleep at the ****wheel****.

他在****駕駛途中****睡著了。

2. She took the ****wheel**** for the final part of the journey.

最後一段路由她****接手駕駛****。

At / behind the wheel

7. at the wheel

= driving a vehicle

****在駕駛；掌握方向盤****

Examples

1. He had been ****at the wheel**** for three hours.

他已經****駕駛****了三個小時。

2. Never use your phone while ****at the wheel****.

****駕駛時****不要使用手機。

8. behind the wheel

= in the driver's position; driving

在駕駛；坐在駕駛座上

Examples

1. She is very confident **behind the wheel**.

她**駕駛時**很有信心。

2. He spent most of the day **behind the wheel**.

他那天大部分時間都在**開車**。

9. take the wheel

A. literal

= take control of driving

接手駕駛；接掌方向盤

B. figurative

= take control of a situation

接手掌控；主持大局

Examples

1. I was tired, so she **took the wheel**.

我累了，所以由她**接手開車**。

2. When the manager left, his deputy **took the wheel**.

經理離開後，由副手**接手掌控局面**。

Machinery

10. wheel — rotating part of a machine

= circular rotating component forming part of a machine or mechanism

輪；轉輪；機械輪

Examples

1. The machine contains several small **wheels**.

這部機器內有幾個小型**轉輪**。

2. The **wheel** turns when the motor starts.

馬達啟動時，這個**輪子**就會轉動。

11. gear wheel / cogwheel

= toothed wheel that engages with another toothed part to transmit motion

齒輪

Examples

1. The mechanism contains several **gear wheels**.

這個機械裝置含有幾個**齒輪**。

2. The damaged **cogwheel** had to be replaced.

損壞的**齒輪**必須更換。

Pottery

12. potter's wheel

= rotating horizontal disk used for shaping clay into pottery

陶輪；拉坯機

Examples

1. She shaped the clay on a **potter's wheel**.

她在**陶輪**上把黏土塑形。

2. Learning to use a **potter's wheel** takes practice.

學習使用**拉坯機**需要練習。

Spinning / textile

13. spinning wheel

= traditional machine with a large wheel used to spin fibers into thread or yarn

紡車；紡紗車

Examples

1. The museum displayed an old **spinning wheel**.
博物館展示了一部古老的**紡車**。
2. Wool was traditionally spun using a **spinning wheel**.
羊毛傳統上會利用**紡車**紡成紗線。

Games / chance

14. wheel — rotating device used to select a result

= circular device divided into sections and spun to determine a prize, number, choice, etc.

轉盤；輪盤

Examples

1. Spin the **wheel** to win a prize.
轉動**轉盤**來贏取獎品。
2. The pointer stopped on the largest prize on the **wheel**.
指針停在**轉盤**上最大的獎項。

15. roulette wheel

= spinning numbered wheel used in roulette

輪盤賭桌上的輪盤

Examples

1. The ball moved around the **roulette wheel**.
小球沿著**輪盤**轉動。
2. The dealer spun the **roulette wheel**.
荷官轉動了**輪盤**。

Wheels — vehicle

16. wheels — vehicle

Informal:

= car or other means of road transport

****車；交通工具****

Examples

1. I finally got some new ****wheels****.

我終於買了輛****新車****。

2. Do you have ****wheels****, or should we take the bus?

你有****車****嗎？還是我們搭巴士？

Informal and context-dependent.

Verb: move something on wheels

17. wheel — push or move something that has wheels

= push, pull, or guide something along on its wheels

****推著……移動；用輪子推行****

Examples

1. A nurse ****wheeled the patient**** into the room.

護士用輪椅把病人****推進房間****。

2. He ****wheeled the bicycle**** through the gate.

他推著單車****穿過大門****。

Major verb sense.

18. wheel something in / out / away

= move something somewhere on wheels

****把……推進 / 推出 / 推走****

Examples

1. They ****wheeled in**** another bed.

他們又****推進來****一張床。

2. The equipment was **wheeled away** after the event.
活動後，設備被**推走了**。

Verb: turn suddenly

19. wheel — turn around quickly

= suddenly turn one's body or direction

猛然轉身；突然轉向

Examples

1. She **wheeled around** when she heard her name.
她聽到自己的名字時**猛然轉身**。

2. He **wheeled** and ran back toward the house.
他**猛地轉身**跑回屋子。

20. wheel around / round

= turn quickly to face another direction

迅速轉身；猛然回頭

Examples

1. He **wheeled around** to face me.
他**猛然轉身**面向我。

2. She **wheeled round** in surprise.
她驚訝地**猛然回頭**。

Circular movement

21. wheel — move in a broad circle

= move or turn around in a circular path

盤旋；迴旋

Especially used of birds, aircraft, groups, etc.

Examples

1. Birds **wheeled above** the cliffs.
鳥群在懸崖上空**盤旋**。
2. The aircraft **wheeled** and headed back toward the airport.
飛機**迴轉**後飛回機場方向。

22. wheeling birds

= birds circling or turning through the air
盤旋的鳥群

Examples

1. We watched gulls **wheeling overhead**.
我們看著海鷗在頭頂**盤旋**。
2. Eagles **wheeled in the sky**.
老鷹在天空中**盤旋**。

Wheelchair

23. wheelchair

= chair fitted with wheels, used by someone who cannot walk easily or at all
輪椅

Examples

1. The entrance is accessible to **wheelchair** users.
入口方便**輪椅**使用者進出。
2. He uses a **wheelchair** for longer journeys.
較長距離時他會使用**輪椅**。

Lexicalized high-frequency family member.

Wheelhouse

24. wheelhouse — ship

= enclosed area from which a ship or boat is steered

****駕駛室；舵房****

Examples

1. The captain returned to the ****wheelhouse****.

船長回到****駕駛室****。

2. The controls are located inside the ****wheelhouse****.

控制設備位於****舵房****內。

25. in someone's wheelhouse

Especially AmE, figurative:

= within someone's area of expertise, ability, or strong interest

****在某人的專長範圍內；正是某人擅長的領域****

Examples

1. Data analysis is right ****in her wheelhouse****.

數據分析正是她****擅長的領域****。

2. That type of project is not really ****in my wheelhouse****.

那類專案其實不太屬於我的****專長範圍****。

Very useful modern idiom.

Third wheel

26. third wheel

= extra person accompanying a couple and feeling unnecessary or awkward

****電燈泡；多餘的第三者****

Examples

1. I felt like a ****third wheel**** with the newly married couple.

跟那對新婚夫婦在一起，我覺得自己像個****電燈泡****。

2. He did not want to be a **third wheel** on their date.

他不想在他們約會時當**電燈泡**。

Very high-value idiom.

Reinvent the wheel

27. reinvent the wheel

= waste effort creating something that already exists or solving a problem already solved

重複發明已有的東西；多此一舉地重新做已有方案

Examples

1. We can use the existing system instead of **reinventing the wheel**.

我們可以使用現有系統，不必**重新發明輪子 / 重複造已有方案**。

2. There is no need to **reinvent the wheel**.

沒必要**把已有的東西重新做一遍**。

Very common business/technical expression.

Set / put the wheels in motion

28. set the wheels in motion

= begin a process that will continue developing

啟動程序；開始推動事情發展

Examples

1. The meeting **set the wheels in motion** for the project.

那場會議正式**啟動了專案的推進程序**。

2. One phone call **set the wheels in motion**.

一通電話便**讓整件事開始運作**。

29. wheels are in motion

= a process has started and is now progressing

****事情已開始運作；程序已啟動****

Examples

1. The ****wheels are already in motion****.

****事情已經開始運作了**。**

2. Once the ****wheels were in motion****, it was difficult to stop the plan.

一旦****程序啟動****，計畫便很難停止。

Grease / oil the wheels

30. grease the wheels

= make a process, system, or arrangement operate more easily

****使事情進行得更順利；疏通運作****

Examples

1. Good communication can ****grease the wheels**** of cooperation.

良好溝通可以****令合作進行得更順利****。

2. A little flexibility helped ****grease the wheels****.

一點彈性有助於****讓事情順利推進****。

Wheels come off

31. the wheels come off

Informal:

= a plan, organization, relationship, performance, etc. begins to fail badly

****開始全面失控；事情開始崩盤****

Examples

1. The project was going well until ****the wheels came off****.

專案原本進展良好，後來卻****開始全面失控****。

2. In the second half, ****the wheels came off**** for the team.

到了下半場，球隊的表現開始****徹底崩盤****。

Wheels within wheels

32. wheels within wheels

= complicated hidden influences, arrangements, or processes behind a situation

****錯綜複雜的幕後關係 / 運作****

Examples

1. The case involved ****wheels within wheels****.
這宗事件背後有很多****錯綜複雜的內情****。
2. There seemed to be ****wheels within wheels**** behind the decision.
那項決定背後似乎存在****複雜的幕後運作****。

Established but lower-frequency.

Big wheel

33. big wheel

Informal, somewhat dated:

= powerful or important person

****大人物；有權勢的人****

Examples

1. He became a ****big wheel**** in the industry.
他成了業界的****大人物****。
2. Several local ****big wheels**** attended the event.
幾名當地****重要人物****出席了活動。

Lower priority.

Wheeler-dealer

34. wheeler-dealer

= person who aggressively and cleverly makes business or political deals, often using influence and informal arrangements

****善於鑽營交易的人；手腕靈活的交易者****

Examples

1. He had a reputation as a ****wheeler-dealer****.

他以善於****鑽營交易****聞名。

2. The businessman was a skilled ****wheeler-dealer****.

那名商人是個很有手腕的****交易高手****。

Often carries a slightly negative implication.

Key contrasts

35. wheel vs tire / tyre

****wheel****

= whole circular rotating structure attached to a vehicle

****車輪****

****tire / tyre****

= rubber outer part fitted around the wheel

****輪胎****

Compare:

> damaged wheel

> 車輪損壞

> flat tire

> 輪胎沒氣

A ****tire**** is part of the wheel assembly, not normally the entire wheel.

36. wheel vs steering wheel

****wheel****

= broad word for a rotating circular object

****steering wheel****

= wheel used specifically to control a vehicle's direction

****方向盤****

In driving context, however:

> take the wheel

> → ****接手駕駛****

So ****wheel**** alone can stand for ****steering wheel****.

37. wheel vs circle

****circle****

= circular shape

****圓形；圓圈****

****wheel****

= circular object designed to rotate or function mechanically

****輪；輪子****

A circle does not necessarily rotate.

38. wheel vs roll

****wheel****

= noun for a rotating object, or verb meaning move something on wheels / turn

****roll****

= move by turning over repeatedly or move smoothly along a surface

****滾動****

Compare:

> wheel the bicycle into the garage

> 把單車****推進****車房

> the ball rolled down the hill

> 球****滾下****山坡

39. wheel vs spin

****spin****

= rotate rapidly around a central point

****旋轉****

****wheel****

= may refer to broad circular movement or a rotating object, not necessarily fast

Compare:

> spin the wheel

> ****轉動輪盤****

Here ****wheel**** is the object and ****spin**** is the action.

Meaning map

The central physical concept is:

****a circular object that rotates around a central point****

From this develop:

Vehicle

car wheel

→ ****車輪****

Driving

the wheel

→ ****方向盤****

Passage

Ferris wheel

→ ****摩天輪****

Machinery

gear wheel

→ ****機械輪 / 齒輪****

Craft

potter's wheel

→ **陶輪**

Games

prize wheel

→ **轉盤**

The verb develops from movement involving rotation:

Move an object

wheel a patient into a room

→ **推著病人進房間**

Human movement

wheel around

→ **猛然轉身**

Birds

wheel overhead

→ **在空中盤旋**

The image of machinery continuing to turn then produces several figurative expressions:

> **set the wheels in motion**

> → 啟動事情

> **grease the wheels**

> → 使事情順利運作

> **the wheels come off**

> → 整件事開始失控

And other lexicalized expressions include:

> **third wheel**

> → 電燈泡

> **reinvent the wheel**

> → 重複製造已有的解決方案

> **in someone's wheelhouse**

> → 在某人的專長範圍內

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
wheel — circular rotating object	繞中心軸轉動的圓形輪子 / 輪
wheel — vehicle	汽車、單車等接觸地面並轉動的車輪
Ferris wheel	裝有乘客座艙並垂直旋轉的大型遊樂設施；摩天輪
steering wheel	駕駛用來控制車輛方向的方向盤
the wheel — driving	駕駛語境中的方向盤 / 駕駛控制
at the wheel	正在駕駛車輛
behind the wheel	處於駕駛位置；正在駕駛
take the wheel — literal	接手駕駛 / 掌握方向盤
take the wheel — figurative	接手掌控某件事 / 局面
wheel — machine part	機械中會旋轉的圓形部件
gear wheel / cogwheel	有齒並傳遞機械運動的齒輪
potter's wheel	製陶時旋轉黏土用的陶輪 / 拉坯機
spinning wheel	把纖維紡成紗線的傳統紡車
wheel — game device	旋轉後決定號碼、獎品等的轉盤
roulette wheel	輪盤賭中旋轉的號碼輪盤
wheels — vehicle informal	非正式：汽車 / 交通工具
wheel — move something	推著有輪子的物件 / 設備移動
wheel something in/out/away	把有輪子的物件推進 / 推出 / 推走
wheel — turn suddenly	突然轉身或迅速改變方向
wheel around/round	猛然轉身 / 迅速回頭
wheel — circular movement	沿圓形路徑迴旋 / 盤旋
wheelchair	裝有輪子、供行動不便者乘坐的輪椅
wheelhouse — ship	船上操控船隻的駕駛室 / 舵房
in someone's wheelhouse	屬於某人的專長、能力或熟悉領域
third wheel	陪著一對情侶而顯得多餘的人；電燈泡
reinvent the wheel	浪費力氣重新創造已有的解決方案
set the wheels in motion	啟動一連串程序，使事情開始發展
wheels are in motion	事情 / 程序已經啟動並開始推進
grease the wheels	令程序、合作或事情運作得更加順暢
the wheels come off	非正式：計畫、組織等開始嚴重失控 / 崩盤
wheels within wheels	背後存在錯綜複雜的關係、安排或內情
big wheel	非正式、較舊：有權勢 / 重要的大人物
wheeler-dealer	善於利用人脈、手腕進行交易的人

Passage recap

> “Soon, we were sitting on a bench near the **Ferris wheel** with cups of lemonade in our hands.”

Here:

Ferris wheel = a very large upright rotating amusement ride carrying passengers around its outer edge

Best Traditional Chinese:

摩天輪

Natural contextual translation:

不久，我們坐在摩天輪附近的一張長椅上，手裡各拿著一杯檸檬水。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

wheel in **Ferris wheel**

= the large circular rotating structure forming the amusement ride

輪；旋轉輪

But the complete compound is:

> **Ferris wheel**

> → **摩天輪**

The major learner splits are:

> **car wheel**

> → 車輪

> **steering wheel**

> → 方向盤

> **at the wheel**

> → 正在駕駛

> **potter's wheel**

> → 陶輪

> **wheel a patient into the room**

> → 把病人**推進房間**

> **wheel around**

> → **猛然轉身**

> birds **wheel overhead**

> → 鳥群在頭頂**盤旋**

And the figurative family is especially productive:

> **third wheel**

> → **電燈泡**

> **reinvent the wheel**

> → **把已有的方案重新做一遍**

> **set the wheels in motion**

> → **啟動事情**

> **the wheels come off**

> → **事情開始崩盤 / 失控**

> **in my wheelhouse**

> → **在我的專長範圍內**

So the passage uses the literal **rotating circular structure** branch inside the lexicalized amusement-park compound **Ferris wheel**.